

Iluvatar (9903.HK): China AI demand to drive growth ahead; Shipments ramping up with product mix upgrade; Buy

We are positive on Iluvatar and see the strong China AI chips demand (read more: [CHIPS IV: China Semis self-sufficiency builds](#)) supporting the company's growth ahead. China CSPs' 2Q26 capex reflects the ongoing AI spending: (1) Tencent's 2Q26 capex up 176% YoY to Rmb52.8bn ([link](#)), (2) Baidu's 2Q26 capex up 202% YoY to Rmb11.4bn, and (3) Baba's 2Q26 capex up 75% YoY to Rmb67.7bn. We expect Iluvatar's net income to grow at +104% CAGR in 2027-30E, driven by (1) China AI capex upcycle, (2) growing local AI ecosystem, including AI chips, servers, networking, foundation models, AI applications, etc, (3) product mix upgrade towards AI chips with stronger computing performance and higher ASP, (4) client base expansion towards local CSPs. We raise Iluvatar's AI chip shipments estimates in coming years to reflect our positive view on the company riding on the growing AI ecosystem in China. Maintain Buy.

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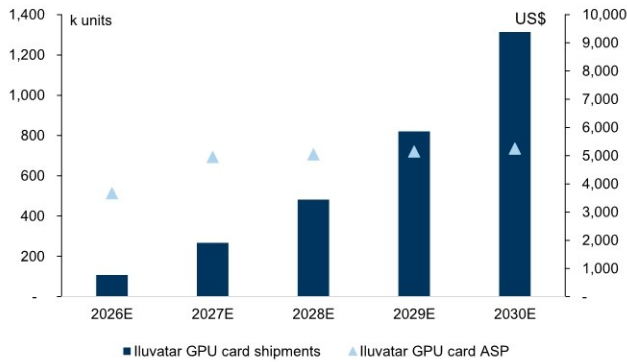
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Exhibit 1: Iluvatar's GPU card shipment and ASP trends

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Iluvatar's revenue by products

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

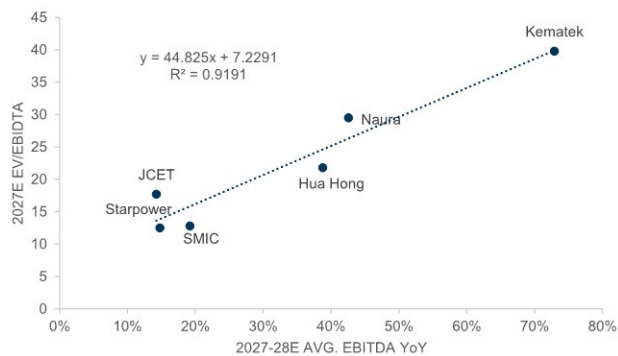
Earnings revision: We factor in Iluvatar's 1H26 net income guidance and raise our 2027-30E net incomes by 20% / 19% / 17% / 11%, mainly on higher revenues. 2027-30E revenues are revised up by 49% / 45% / 37% / 27%, mainly on higher AI chip shipments and product mix upgrade towards next-generation products driving blended ASP, reflecting our positive view on China AI spending and localization trend. Our 2026-30E GMs are revised down, considering customers expansion toward CSPs, who have stronger bargaining power and industry practice of better ASP on larger procurement. We raise our 2026-30E R&D investments to support the company's product specification upgrades. Our net income in 2026E turns profitable, considering the non-op gains from fair value gains on financial assets.

Exhibit 3: Earnings revision

Rmb m	2026E			2027E			2028E			2029E			2030E		
	Old	New	Chg	Old	New	Chg	Old	New	Chg	Old	New	Chg	Old	New	Chg
Revenues	2,970	2,970	0%	6,683	9,972	49%	12,579	18,190	45%	22,946	31,511	37%	40,462	51,461	27%
GP	1,579	1,431	-9%	3,547	5,065	43%	6,630	9,326	41%	11,797	16,097	36%	20,830	26,192	26%
EBITDA	-292	-639	na	1,111	1,364	23%	2,889	3,493	21%	5,902	6,940	18%	11,816	13,174	11%
Net income	-409	4	na	1,136	1,369	20%	2,777	3,312	19%	5,433	6,343	17%	10,475	11,638	11%
Margins															
GM	53.2%	48.2%		53.1%	50.8%		52.7%	51.3%		51.4%	51.1%		51.5%	50.9%	
OPM	-9.8%	-21.5%		16.6%	13.7%		23.0%	19.2%		25.7%	22.0%		29.2%	25.6%	
NM	-13.8%	0.1%		17.0%	13.7%		22.1%	18.2%		23.7%	20.1%		25.9%	22.6%	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation: We derive our 12M TP of HK\$1,000 (unchanged) based on a discounted 2030E EV / EBITDA methodology to capture the company's long-term growth, in line with our GC Tech coverage. We apply a target EV / EBITDA multiple of 23.4x to our 2030E EBITDA (vs. 26.1x previously), and discount it back to 2027E using a COE of 12.7% (Beta of 1.5, Risk-free rate of 3.0%, and a Market risk premium of 6.5%). Our target EV / EBITDA multiple is derived from: (1) peers' forward-year EV / EBITDA relative to average EBITDA YoY growth; and (2) Iluvatar's forward-year average EBITDA YoY growth (31% in 2031-32E). The target EV / EBITDA multiple cut reflects sector de-rating amid the concerns of AI monetization. **Maintain Buy.**

Exhibit 4: 2030E target EV / EBITDA of 23.4x is derived from the correlation between peers' EV / EBITDA and EBITDA growth


Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: Iluvatar 12M forward P/S


Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: Iluvatar 2030E discounted EV / EBITDA

Rmb m	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2031E	2032E
Iluvatar revenues (US\$m)	74	145	415	1,395	2,544	4,407	7,197	10,004	12,505	
Iluvatar cloud chips (k units)	17	45	107	268	483	821	1,314			
Iluvatar cloud chips ASP (US\$)		3,296	2,986	3,668	4,952	5,051	5,152	5,255		
Revenue	289	540	1,034	2,970	9,972	18,190	31,511	51,461	71,531	89,414
Revenue YoY		87%	92%	187%	236%	82%	73%	63%	39%	25%
GM	49.5%	49.1%	54.0%	48.2%	50.8%	51.3%	51.1%	50.9%	50.5%	50.0%
GP	143	265	558	1,431	5,065	9,326	16,097	26,192	36,123	44,707
Opex ratio	327.3%	213.6%	155.5%	75.1%	38.3%	32.9%	29.6%	25.7%	24.0%	23.0%
OP	(803)	(887)	(1,050)	(799)	1,242	3,350	6,761	12,974	18,956	24,142
OPM	-277.8%	-164.5%	-101.5%	-26.9%	12.5%	18.4%	21.5%	25.2%	26.5%	27.0%
Non-op	(14)	(5)	46	804	208	211	210	103	103	103
Pretax profit	(817)	(892)	(1,004)	4	1,451	3,561	6,971	13,077	19,059	24,245
Tax	-	-	-	-	82	249	627	1,438	2,478	3,637
Tax rate	0%	0%	0%	0%	6%	7%	9%	11%	13%	15%
EBITDA	(698)	(747)	(894)	(639)	1,364	3,493	6,940	13,174	19,130	24,316
EBITDA YoY		na	na	na	na	156%	99%	90%	45%	27%
Net profit	(791)	(892)	(1,004)	4	1,369	3,312	6,343	11,638	16,581	20,608
NP YoY		na	na	na	na	142%	92%	83%	42%	24%
EPS			(5.31)	0.04	5.26	12.74	24.40	44.77	63.78	79.27
EPS YoY				na	na	na	92%	83%	42%	24%
Target EV/EBITDA (sector EV/EBITDA)								23.4		
Target EV/EBITDA x 2030 EBITDA								308,758		
Enterprise value (Rmb, 2027E)					215,785					
Debt					1,050					
Cash					9,338					
Equity value (Rmb, 2027E)					224,073					
Value per share (HKD, 2027E); Target Price					1,000					
Implied EV/Sales				73	22	12	7	4	3	2
Implied P/E				na	164	68	35	19	14	11
COE	12.7%									
Beta	1.5									
Risk-free rate	3.0%									
Market risk premium	6.5%									

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Iluvatar

Valuation: Our 12-month target price of HK\$1,000 is based on 23.4x 2030E EV / EBITDA, discounted back to 2027E at COE of 12.7%. Our target EV / EBITDA multiple is derived from the peers' forward EV / EBITDA vs. EBITDA YoY correlation.

Key downside risks: Lower-than-expected AI chip demand in the China market; Fiercer-than-expected market competition; Slower-than-expected product migration.

9903.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$1,000.00	Price: HK\$361.00	Upside: 177.0%
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Buy	GS Forecast				
Market cap: HK\$93.8bn / \$12.0bn Enterprise value: HK\$83.9bn / \$10.7bn 3m ADTV: HK\$1.2bn / \$155.3mn China Greater China Technology M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	Revenue (Rmb mn) New	1,033.6	2,970.0	9,972.0	18,189.8
	Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	1,033.6	2,970.0	6,683.0	12,579.2
	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	(894.0)	(639.0)	1,364.4	3,493.2
	EPS (Rmb) New	(5.31)	0.04	5.26	12.74
	EPS (Rmb) Old	(5.31)	(1.67)	4.37	10.68
	P/E (X)	NM	NM	58.8	24.3
	P/B (X)	NM	2.9	6.1	4.9
	Dividend yield (%)	NM	0.0	0.0	0.0
	CROCI (%)	(38.8)	3.8	26.8	46.1
	12/25	6/26E	12/26E	6/27E	
EPS (Rmb)	(1.84)	0.41	(0.37)	(0.73)	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 24 Aug 2026 close.

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Iluvar (9903.HK)

Date of report **Target price (HK\$)** **Closing price (HK\$)**

19-Jul-26 1,000.00 495.20

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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